

c. 950 BCE

NEO-ASSYRIAN EMPIRE

Emerging from a “Dark Age” of decline that had afflicted much of the Middle East for more than a century, Assyria began to re-establish its empire. By the time Adad-nirari II came to the throne in 911 BCE, the foundations for a Neo-Assyrian Empire had been laid, and under his leadership it conquered much of Mesopotamia and beyond. Its expansion made it the largest and most powerful empire the world had yet seen.



△ Assyrian bas-relief

Hiram I supplied
Solomon with cedar
wood from Lebanon
to build the Temple
in Jerusalem

c. 930 BCE After Solomon's death, his kingdom divides into Israel in the north, and Judah in the south

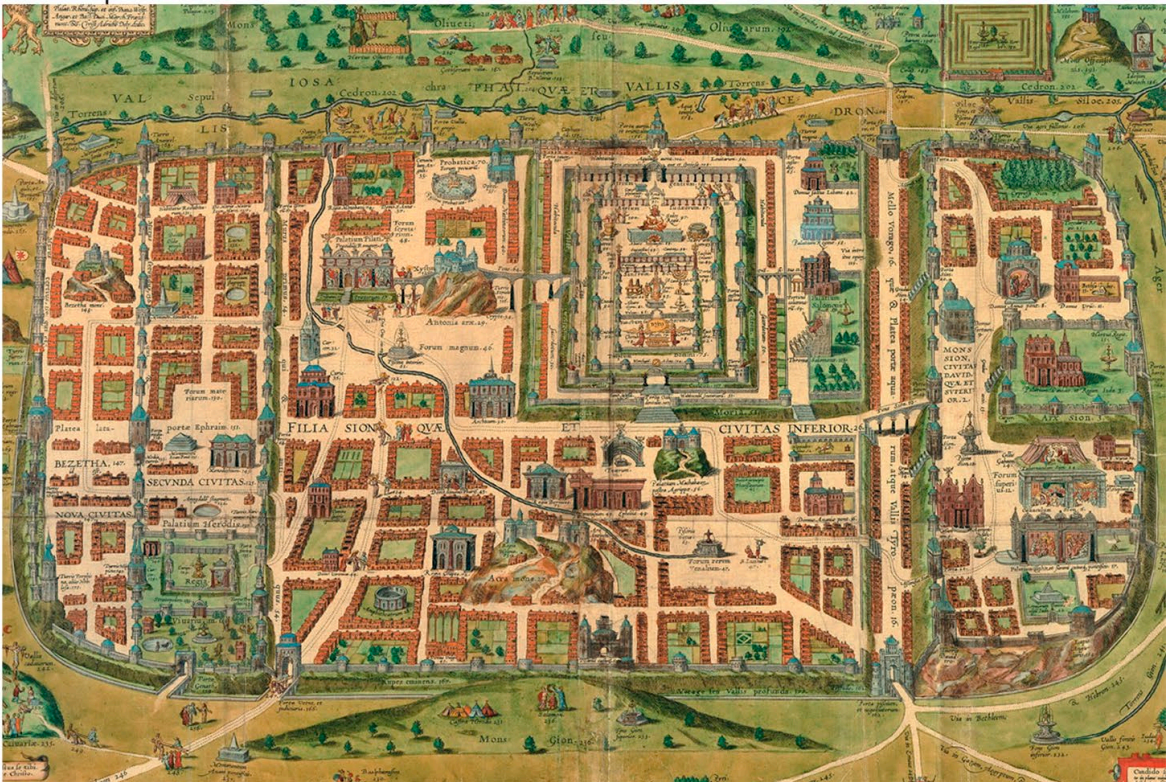
901 BCE

c. 910 BCE Scythia, in central Eurasia, becomes home to nomadic people from the steppes of Asia

c. 950 BCE

FIRST TEMPLE BUILT IN JERUSALEM

According to tradition, King David brought the Ark of the Covenant to Jerusalem. However, it was his son Solomon who had a temple built to house it when he succeeded to the throne of Israel. The First Temple, as it became known, was the spiritual and cultural centre of the city, situated on Mount Moriah (the Temple Mount), until it was destroyed by Babylonians in 586 BCE.



▷ Map of Jerusalem